

What is SIEM? + Install Splunk / Wazuh

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1. Objective

The goal of this task was to understand the SIEM (Security Information and Event Management) concept — log collection, correlation, alerting, and dashboards — and to set up a free SIEM platform (Splunk Free) as hands-on practice.

2. What is a SIEM?

A SIEM (Security Information and Event Management) system collects logs from across an entire organisation (servers, firewalls, laptops, applications) into a single place. It correlates these logs — linking events from different sources together to reveal larger patterns — generates alerts on suspicious activity, and presents everything visually on a dashboard so an analyst can monitor the environment efficiently.

3. Three Benefits of a SIEM

#	Benefit	Explanation
1	Centralized visibility	Logs from thousands of devices (servers, firewalls, laptops, applications) are collected in one place, so an analyst doesn't need to check each system separately.
2	Faster threat detection	Correlating events from different sources reveals patterns a single log alone wouldn't show — e.g. a failed login on one machine followed immediately by a successful login on another.
3	Compliance & reporting	Organisations must retain and report on security logs to meet regulations (e.g. ISO 27001). A SIEM automates this record-keeping and reporting.

4. Installing and Setting Up Splunk

Splunk Enterprise (free tier) was downloaded from splunk.com, installed, and logged into successfully, confirming a working SIEM dashboard setup.

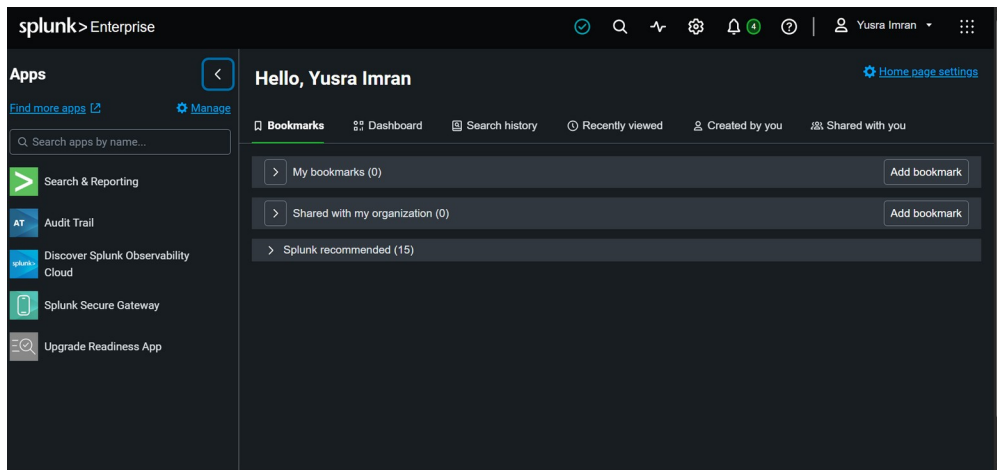


Figure 1: Splunk Enterprise home dashboard, logged in as Yusra Imran.

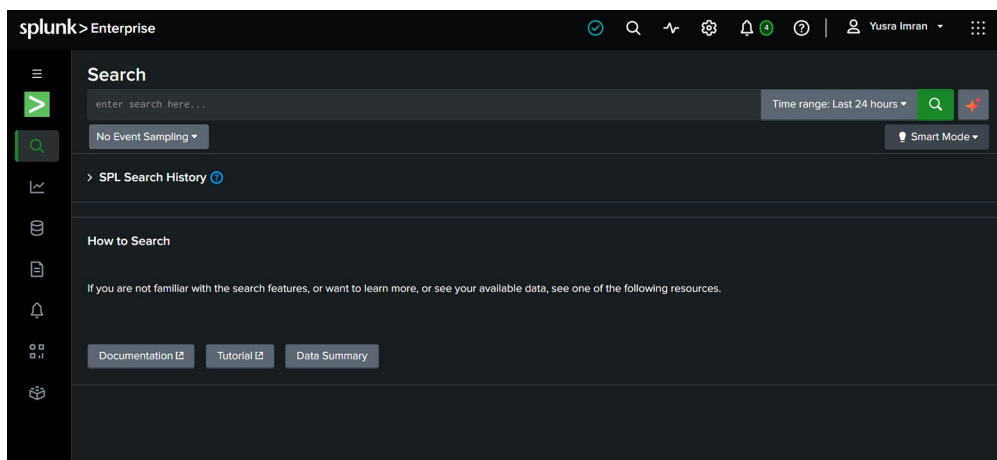


Figure 2: Splunk's Search & Reporting app — the interface used to query and analyse ingested log data.

5. TryHackMe Room Completed (Mandatory Free-Tier Proof)

The required TryHackMe room was completed on the free tier, as mandated by the task.

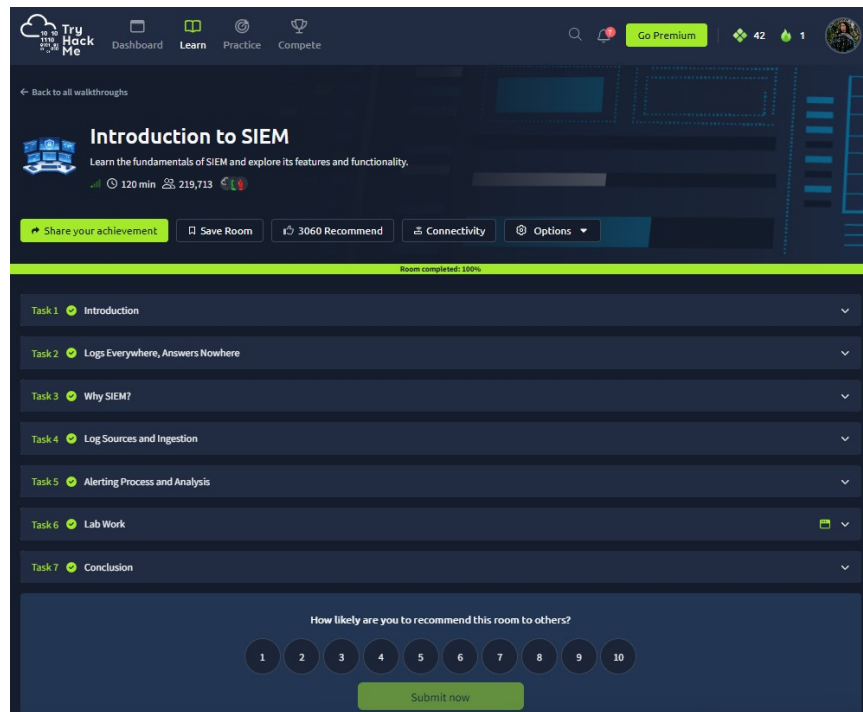


Figure 3: “Introduction to SIEM” room — Room completed: 100%.

6. Conclusion

This task introduced the SIEM concept that underpins most SOC monitoring work: centralising logs, correlating them to detect threats faster, and supporting compliance reporting. Setting up Splunk Enterprise and reaching a working dashboard provided direct, hands-on exposure to the kind of platform a SOC analyst uses daily.